

India's Satellite Kingmaker: How Anurup Pavuluri Is Engineering the Nation's Space Renaissance

The trajectory of India's space revolution can be traced through the precision-engineered corridors of a 3.5-acre facility near Bengaluru, where Ananth Technologies Limited (ATL) has quietly assembled what may be the country's most consequential aerospace success story. At its helm stands Anurup Pavuluri, a Carnegie Mellon-trained engineer whose journey from Google's algorithm optimization teams to spacecraft manufacturing exemplifies India's broader transformation from IT services powerhouse to advanced manufacturing hub.

The numbers validate Pavuluri's vision: ATL recently secured India's first private access to geostationary orbital resources, positioning the company to become the nation's inaugural private GSO communication satellite operator. The approval grants ATL an exclusive orbital slot at 89°E, where it will deploy a Ka-band satellite designed to strengthen India's communication infrastructure.

"We're not just manufacturing satellites; we're manufacturing India's technological sovereignty," Pavuluri reflects, surveying production lines capable of assembling multiple spacecraft. His facility represents more than industrial capacity—it's a strategic bet on India's emergence as a global space

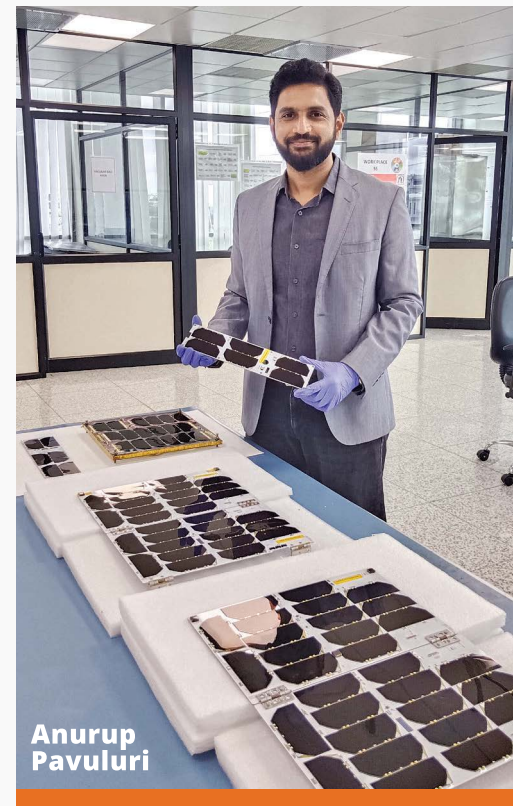
manufacturing powerhouse.

The transformation has been methodical. Since joining his father Dr. Subba Rao's company in 2013, Pavuluri has systematically expanded ATL's capabilities from component supplier to complete spacecraft manufacturer. The company has contributed to over 100 satellites and 80 launch vehicles, establishing itself as ISRO's most reliable private partner. Recent milestones include delivering two 400-kg satellites for ISRO's pioneering Space Docking Experiment, showcasing ATL's evolution into mission-critical system integration.

A Silicon Valley veteran is transforming India's space ambitions from his Bengaluru facility, building satellites and challenging global aerospace giants one launch at a time.

Pavuluri's Silicon Valley pedigree—spanning Google, Pinterest, Amazon, and Microsoft—provides crucial context for understanding global technology ecosystems. His work taught him to think in terms of massive scale and systematic precision, skills now applied to aerospace manufacturing with surgical accuracy. "The principles of scalable systems design translate beautifully to satellite production," he explains. "Whether processing billions of web pages or manufacturing spacecraft components, reliability and precision remain non-negotiable."

ATL's competitive advantage lies in its manufacturing velocity and cost efficiency. The facility can produce up to 20 small satellites monthly and



eight large satellites simultaneously over 12-18 months—capabilities that position India as a viable alternative to traditional aerospace supply chains. Strategic partnerships, including a recent agreement with multinational nanosatellite integrator NanoAvionics, demonstrate ATL's expanding global footprint.

"We're witnessing a fundamental restructuring of global aerospace supply chains," Pavuluri observes. "India isn't just participating in this shift—we're driving it."

The company's ₹3,000 crore GSO satellite project, expected operational by 2028, represents more than a business venture; it's a declaration of India's space-age ambitions. As global competitors like Starlink and OneWeb reshape satellite communications, ATL positions itself as India's indigenous answer, promising broadband connectivity to the nation's most remote regions while reducing dependence on foreign providers.

For Pavuluri, the mission extends beyond commercial success. It's about constructing the infrastructure for India's knowledge economy transition—from software services to hardware innovation, one satellite at a time.